

Make Winning an Attitude: Visualize Your Victory, Featuring Timothy Alexander

Timothy Alexander, Director of UAB Football Character Excellence Program & Life Coach

As Pat said, “We simulate and prepare. We expect to win because we rehearse it. I believe you get what you deserve.” When you’re already working hard and making progress towards your goal, it can be tempting to get caught up in wins along the way. Don’t let someone pass you because you were celebrating on the way to the finish line.

A winning attitude maintains focus on victory and prepares for it. As Pat said, “There are some concrete ways to create a winning attitude. But nothing beats practicing it. When you prepare to win, belief comes easily.”

A winning attitude visualizes and practices every path to victory. This works in multiple professional settings. In sales, for example, if you have a big presentation, it’s better if you rehearse your talking points and delivery repeatedly until everything feels natural. By the time the meeting arrives, you are prepared to handle multiple outcomes. You are ready to execute the presentation with poise and confidence because you’ve already visualized your victory.

Coach Summitt regularly forced her players to make game-time decisions in practice. She put a time and a score on the clock and simulated end-of-game pressure by giving her players the ball and asking them to make the calls. No matter the opponent, her players believe they could outplay any competition in high-pressure situations because they’d done it all year in practice. They were prepared for victory.

To claim victory, you have to see it before anyone else sees it. You have to be present to your vision, so immersed in your dream, that you recognize opportunities right away. A winning attitude doesn’t wait to be in the right place at the right time. A winning attitude looks ahead to victory and gets there first. When you focus on your dreams, you have clear, established goals.

Not only do you see what needs to happen in everyday life to meet your goals, you visualize what victory looks like beyond your goals. A winning attitude has no finish line. Every experience is an opportunity to get better and go farther. A winning attitude always leads to more opportunity. If you’re not dedicated to your dream, then you’re just a dreamer.

Choose to be a winner by pursuing your dream every single day, in every area of your life. Visualize your success and make victory an instinct.